

EXECUTIVE CHURN PLAYBOOK

Strategic Remapping & Continuity Framework for Customer Success

Phase 1: Immediate Internal Triage (0–24 Hours)

- **Update CRM Status:** Immediately change the contact status in HubSpot to "At Risk" or "Left Company" upon detection to ensure visibility for all teams.
- **Risk Assessment:** Evaluate the account impact. Is this the primary Economic Buyer or the only executive Champion? Determine if there are pending renewals, upgrades, or open support tickets.
- **Account Locking:** Temporarily pause automated outreach or marketing sequences to this contact. This prevents "ghost" messaging that signals a lack of awareness to the remaining team.

Phase 2: Multi-Threading & Discovery (Days 1–5)

- **Identify the "Power Vacuum":** Map out who is stepping into the interim role. Check if the departing executive's direct reports now report to a peer or a higher-level leader.
- **LinkedIn Deep Dive:** Use search filters to monitor for external hires or internal promotions within the department. Watch for "New Hire" announcements at the executive tier.
- **The "Legacy" Search:** Identify 2–3 existing power users or operational stakeholders. These individuals often have the most to lose if the partnership stalls and can serve as internal bridges to new leadership.

Phase 3: Communication Templates

Template A: The "Departure Outreach"

Recipient: The executive transitioning out of the company

Subject: Thank you / Wishing you the best!

"Hi [Name], I saw the news about your move! It's been a pleasure working with you at [Company].

I'd love to stay in touch—wherever you're headed, I'm sure you'll make a huge impact. If there's anyone you recommend I connect with to ensure a smooth transition for the [Product] initiative before you head out, please let me know."

Template B: The "Interim/Replacement Outreach"

Recipient: The new stakeholder, interim lead, or supervisor

Subject: Ensuring continuity for [Company] x [Product]

"Hi [Name], as [Departing Name] moves on to their next chapter, I want to ensure your team doesn't lose any momentum with [Project Name].

We've recently achieved [Specific Goal/Milestone], and I'd like to share a brief 'State of the Union' with you to ensure our roadmap remains aligned with your current priorities."

Phase 4: Remapping Workflow

- **Step 1: Org Chart Update:** Update the relationship map in the CRM. Formally designate the new Economic Buyer, Champion, and any new Influencers identified during discovery.
- **Step 2: Executive Alignment Call:** Secure an alignment meeting with the new stakeholder

- **Step 3: Business Case Re-Validation:** Re-confirm the value proposition. New executives often audit existing vendors; proactively presenting the ROI achieved to date is critical to prevent churn.